

BIT Modern Slavery Policy

1. Statement

- 1.1. This document has been created by, and with the backing and support of, the senior management of BIT Group (BIT), to ensure company-wide compliance with our regulatory, legal, and contractual obligations.
- 1.2. This document forms part of BIT's quality, business operations, information security, continuity and resilience management systems, which has been implemented as part of BIT's business strategy, which itself is part of the overall business strategy

2. Purpose

2.1 The purpose of this policy is to:

- a) set out our responsibilities, and of those working for and on our behalf, in observing and upholding our position on modern slavery and human trafficking; and
- b) provide information to those working for and on our behalf on how to identify and report concerns regarding modern slavery and human trafficking.

3. Scope

- 3.1. The contents of this document apply to all current employees and contractors who work either on-site or off-site.

4. Responsibilities

- 4.1. The Board of Directors takes full responsibility for any ad-hoc or scheduled reviewing of this document, including any updates or changes as required. This document must be reviewed at least annually or when suitable according to operations, staff changes or any other event that may impact on this document's purpose or content.
- 4.2. All employees are responsible for the success of this policy and should endeavour to read and understand the policy. Employees are encouraged to provide feedback to policy owners.

5. Objective

- 5.1. This document has been created to align with the following objectives:
- 5.2. Increase the awareness of organisational policy toward modern slavery.

6. Modern Slavery Policy

At BIT we are committed to preventing modern slavery and human trafficking in all aspects of our operations and supply chains. This policy outlines our approach to ensuring compliance with the UK Modern Slavery Act 2015 and other relevant international legislation.

6.1 Policy Statement

Modern slavery, encompassing slavery, servitude, forced or compulsory labour, and human trafficking, is a crime and a violation of fundamental human rights. We have a zero-tolerance approach to any form of modern slavery within our organization and supply chains.

6.2 Policy Responsibilities

- **6.2.1 Board of Directors:** Overall responsibility for ensuring this policy complies with legal and ethical standards.
- **6.2.2 Management:** Implement and enforce effective systems and controls to prevent modern slavery.
- **6.2.3 Employees:** Report any concerns related to modern slavery and adhere to this policy.

6.3 Due Diligence Processes

We are committed to implementing and maintaining effective systems and controls to mitigate the risk of modern slavery within our operations and supply chains. Our due diligence processes include:

- **6.3.1 Supplier Vetting:** Conducting thorough background checks on potential suppliers to assess their compliance with modern slavery laws.
- **6.3.2 Risk Assessments:** Regularly evaluating the risk of modern slavery in our supply chains and operations.
- **6.3.3 Audits:** Performing audits of suppliers and partners to ensure adherence to our anti-slavery policies.
- **6.3.4 Training:** Providing training to employees and suppliers to raise awareness of modern slavery issues and reporting mechanisms.

6.4 Reporting and Compliance

We encourage all employees, suppliers, and business partners to report any concerns related to modern slavery. Reports can be made confidentially through our established reporting channels.

- **6.4.1 Whistleblowing Policy:** Ensures protection for individuals reporting concerns in good faith.
- **6.4.2 Investigations:** All reports will be investigated promptly, and appropriate remedial actions will be taken.
- **6.4.3 Non-Compliance:** Failure to comply with this policy may result in disciplinary action, including termination of contracts or employment.

7. Monitoring and Review

We are committed to continuous improvement in our approach to combating modern slavery. This policy will be reviewed annually to ensure its effectiveness and relevance.

- **7.1 Performance Indicators:** We will monitor the effectiveness of our anti-slavery measures through:
 - **7.1.1 Training Completion Rates:** Tracking the percentage of employees and suppliers who have completed modern slavery training.
 - **7.1.2 Audit Results:** Assessing the outcomes of supplier audits related to modern slavery compliance.
 - **7.1.3 Incident Reports:** Recording and analysing reports of suspected modern slavery incidents.
- **7.2 Annual Statement:** In accordance with the Modern Slavery Act 2015, we will publish an annual statement detailing the steps taken to prevent modern slavery in our operations and supply chains. This statement will be approved by the Board of Directors and made publicly available on our website.

8. Commitment to Ethical Conduct

We are dedicated to conducting our business with integrity and in accordance with the highest ethical standards. Our commitment to preventing modern slavery is an integral part of our broader corporate social responsibility objectives.

- **8.1 Supplier Code of Conduct:** We have established a Supplier Code of Conduct that outlines our expectations regarding labour standards, human rights, and ethical behaviour. All suppliers are required to adhere to this code as a condition of doing business with us.

- **8.2 Collaboration:** We engage with industry partners, non-governmental organizations, and other stakeholders to share best practices and collaborate on initiatives aimed at eradicating modern slavery.
- **8.3 Transparency:** We are committed to maintaining transparency in our efforts to combat modern slavery and will provide regular updates on our progress to stakeholders.

This Modern Slavery Policy reflects our commitment to acting ethically and with integrity in all our business relationships. We expect the same high standards from all our contractors, suppliers, and other business partners.

9. Exemptions

- 9.1 Exemptions provide employees with a way to request exception to controls, policies, or procedures that they are unable to comply with, any exemption request must be submitted to the Senior Management Team.
- 9.2 Upon submission of an exemption request, the Senior Management Team will assess the request based on its merits and consequences, the Senior Management Team will respond to all exemption requests within 30 days.

10. Non-Compliance

- 10.1 Any violation of this policy may cause BIT to review its relationship with the violator, including such measures as contract termination or legal action.

11. Policy Approval

- 11.1 This policy has been approved by the Board of Directors of BIT Group and is fully supported by senior management. It is effective immediately upon the date of issue and until further notice or revision.

12. Change Control

12.1 This document is released and approved as follows:

Date	Version	Author	Approved by	Change/Review
08/11/2023	1.0	ST	MD	Initial implementation.
09/12/2024	1.1	LD	MD	Latest HR advised content.

13. Applicable standards

13.1 This policy is legislative, and within our organisation, applies to following standards:

- 13.1.1 ISO 9001:2015
- 13.1.2 ISO 14001:2015
- 13.1.3 ISO 18788:2015
- 13.1.4 ISO 22301:2019
- 13.1.5 ISO 22342:2023
- 13.1.6 ISO 27001: 2022
- 13.1.7 ISO 45001:2018

End of document.